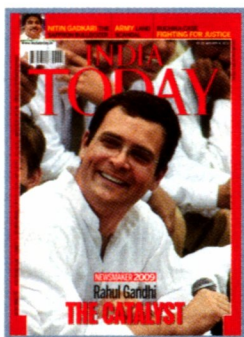


terrorism in the country ("Curtains for Zardari", December 28). This could mark the beginning of the end for Zardari. Pakistan's attempts at uprooting corruption are laudable, but the truth is that for all his faults, there is no denying the fact that Zardari tried to reach out to India and refrained from indulging in anti-India rhetoric. NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*



and the field work undertaken by Rahul Gandhi. BICHU MUTTATHARA, *Pune*

Right Choice

Nitin Gadkari has taken the right decision by not willing to contest any elections ("The Saffron Flyover", January 4). Being the president of a national party is in itself a huge task requiring full-time attention to party affairs exclusively. A policy

should be formulated whereby a Parliamentarian, state legislator or member of civic body may not be able to hold any other post either in the government or in the party or even in any other private body or organisation so as to pay greater attention to his/her constituency. MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Conscience Call

It is shocking that so many generals of the army are involved in land scam cases ("Dent in the Brass", January 4). They have set a bad example for the armed forces. The case should now be investigated and exemplary punishment must be awarded to the offenders. LT-COL (RETD) RANJIT SINHA, *Kochi*

JANUARY 4, 2010

What has distinguished Rahul from other seasoned politicians is his simplicity which has often been seen as naivete. He is a politician who has shunned power.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Newsmaker 2009: Rahul Gandhi, The Catalyst

Young Gun

There is no gainsaying that Rahul Gandhi has been heralding the kinetics of change both within and outside the party ever since he has taken up politics as a full time profession ("Rahul Gandhi: The Catalyst", January 4). He has become the cynosure of all eyes, including of his political opponents, for obvious reasons. The Congress has received a fresh lease of life thanks to the charismatic leadership provided by Sonia Gandhi

Idea of Injustice

Ruchika Girhotra's tragic story is not only about justice delayed and denied, it's also about the ruthlessness with which morally corrupt police officers seek to silence the victims of their misdeeds ("Feeble Justice", January 4). While it is for the judiciary to decide whether justice has been done in this case, it would be in order to underscore the fact that when powerful individuals—especially police officers, bureaucrats and politicians—get away lightly for their crimes, society loses respect for the law of the land.

J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

The Ruchika case is an indelible blot on the face of the judicial system. However, social organisations, the media and some honest public representatives deserve accolades for taking the lead in the fight against injustice and the persecution which Ruchika and her family suffered.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MARCH 1-15, 1980

Lure of the Homeland

The venue was the Palace of the Dalai Lama in Upper Dharamsala, a sleepy valley town in the foothills of the Himalayas in North India. A five-member Tibetan team had just returned from a three-month sojourn in Tibet—after exploring the possibility of a solution to the Tibetan issue. As the jeeps carrying the team members roared towards the Dalai Lama's Palace, Tibetan refugees made a beeline to get entry into this historic meeting. Security men pushed back the onlookers. The gate closed and the all-important meeting that can have a far-reaching effect on the Tibetan issue began. Phuntsog Takla and Juchen Namgyal, who were co-leaders of the team, told the Dalai Lama that the Chinese leadership was very eager to come to an understanding with him. "The Chinese want you and about 5,000 of us to return; they are not interested in all the 1,10,000 Tibetan refugees living in India, Nepal, Bhutan and some Western countries," Takla told the Dalai Lama. **by Dilip Ganguly**



THE
DALAI
LAMA

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